



Monsters, Mech Suits and Mind Games

One of the most revered names in gaming, Shinji Mikami is responsible for a lot of our gaming memories.

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Japanese game developers are quite a strange bunch, aren't they? From the quirky, youthful exuberance of Shigeru Miyamoto to the esoteric insanity of Hidetaka Miyazaki, they have always pushed the envelope when it comes to cutting-edge gaming.

They've paved the way for a wide range of new gameplay ideas that are now commonplace in modern titles. Right from the inception of the industry, there have been mavericks in Japan, people who have pushed

boundaries and changed how we view video games. One of these names is Shinji Mikami.

Also known as the master of modern horror, Mikami is most famous for his work on the Resident Evil series, with RE4 being his crowning achievement. Not to take anything away from the first three RE titles, but RE4 was a revolutionary game that popularised the third-person survival horror/shooter genre and led to a renaissance period for Capcom. His work has not only influenced a whole generation of gamers but has also

largely changed the way we look at horror in the medium.

Resident Capcom

Like a lot of successful people, Mikami was not interested in what he would eventually be renowned for. In an interview with *Variety*, he stated that he would play arcade games but never really saw game development as a viable job. That is, until a friend nudged him to apply to Capcom. He stated, "A friend of mine had found a flyer advertising some kind of job fair-slash-buffet party Capcom was hold-